Don't build the HUB first. Launch one product SMEs can't say no to, then grow the HUB around it

THE CHALLENGE

- **400,000+ SME accounts**, Egypt's largest business segment, but slow to adopt new technology and very price-sensitive
- They **don't trust digital tools** with their business and prefer dealing with people, so a full AI HUB on day one is the hardest possible sell

THE OPPORTUNITY

- Vodafone Business has already built an AI agent for small businesses, **AI Concierge**, with Google Cloud. It was announced in April 2026 and is not yet offered to Egyptian SMEs
- Vodafone Egypt already sells **010Hotline** and **AI-as-a-Service**, so the building blocks are in place

MY RECOMMENDATION

1. **Bring AI Concierge to Egypt**
   An AI agent that answers on the business's own number. Localised in Egyptian Arabic, it picks up the calls and WhatsApp messages staff can't answer (busy times, after hours, days off) and takes orders and bookings

2. **Partner, don't build**
   Build on the Group's Google Cloud partnership. Egypt adds Egyptian Arabic, SME pricing, and a simple way to buy it

3. **Grow into the HUB step by step**
   Pilot first with existing 010Hotline customers; each phase starts only when the last one proves customers pay and stay

12-MONTH TARGET
illustrative, see slide 4

~145 paying SMEs

EGP 1.1M revenue in year 1

35-48% margin per customer

Egyptian SMEs lose customers every time a call or WhatsApp goes unanswered. An AI agent on their own line picks them up

THE PROBLEM TODAY

SMEs that live on the phone, like restaurants, clinics, brokers and service centres, miss calls at peak hours, after closing and on days off. The customer simply goes elsewhere.

Two real examples:

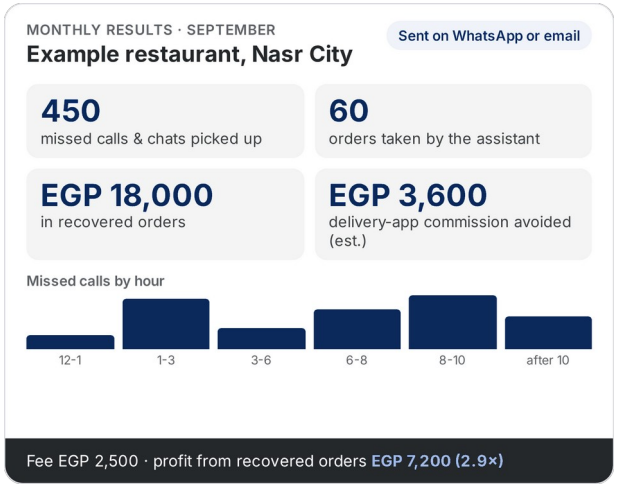
A restaurant
The customer orders from a competitor, or on a delivery app where the restaurant pays ~15-25% commission

A clinic
The patient books with another doctor or through a booking platform, and the visit is lost

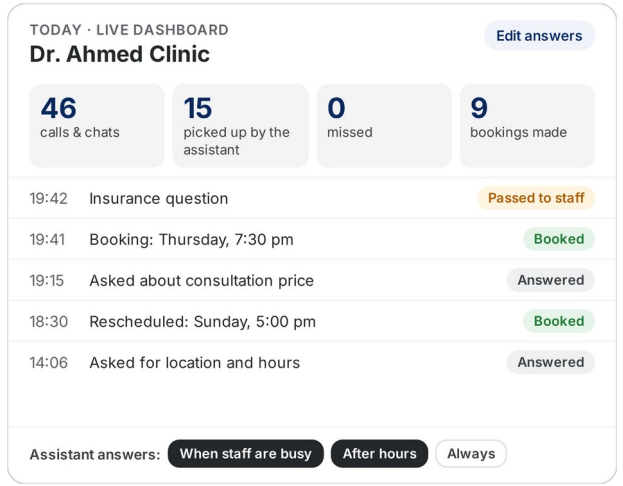
- Delivery apps charge Egyptian restaurants an **estimated 15-25% per order**; in 2022 the **Competition Authority** ordered a dominant platform to stop forcing restaurants into exclusivity and uniform pricing
- SMEs are **slow to trust digital tools**, so the answer must be simple, owner-controlled and proven on their own numbers

WHAT THE PRODUCT LOOKS LIKE (MOCK-UPS, HYPOTHETICAL NUMBERS)

Restaurant: the monthly report the owner receives



Clinic: the owner's live dashboard



WHAT THE ASSISTANT DOES

1 Picks up
calls and WhatsApp staff can't answer

2 Answers
only from approved information

3 Takes
orders and bookings

4 Hands over
everything else to staff

5 Owner decides
when it answers

6 Reports
by WhatsApp or email, PDF or Excel

THE INFRASTRUCTURE

Customer calls or WhatsApps
the SME's usual number
→
010Hotline routes the call
staff first · exists today
→
AI Concierge replies
Google Gemini · Group partnership
→
Approved info only
never guesses · hands over
→
Order or booking to staff
+ owner dashboard (extends Hotline's)

New to build: Egyptian Arabic layer · order-taking flow · Hotline connection · WhatsApp channel. **Everything else already exists**

Sources: commission is an industry estimate (menuviel.com, Talabat fees guide); Egyptian Competition Authority decision, 26 May 2022 (Mondaq); AI Concierge: Google Cloud press release, 22 Apr 2026

From one product to the SME AI HUB in three phases, adding each new service only when the previous one proves itself

PHASE 1 · MONTHS 1-4

Pilot & launch

SERVICES

- Picks up missed calls and WhatsApp messages
- Answers questions, takes orders and bookings
- Hands anything else over to staff

WHO

Pilot: **30 existing 010Hotline customers** in two sectors (e.g. restaurants with own delivery, clinics), set up in months 1-2; months 3-4 measure and fix

Move to Phase 2 only if

- ≥60% keep paying after the free first month
- ≥95% of orders and bookings correct
- Setup done in under 1 hour with templates

PHASE 2 · MONTHS 5-8

Expand

SERVICES

- Deposits and payment links (Vodafone Cash or card)
- Follow-up on customers who asked but didn't book
- Feedback after every visit, plus Google review requests

WHO

20 new setups a month by the delivery team (40% of its capacity) · + brokers, service centres, salons · built on Vodafone SMS & messaging

Move to Phase 3 only if

- ≥30% of customers use 2+ services
- Monthly churn ≤5% and positive margin
- Guided self-setup works for 10 test customers

PHASE 3 · MONTHS 9-12

The SME AI HUB

SERVICES

- E-receipts for the Tax Authority (Law 6 of 2025): link to the SME's own system, or a certified partner's if it has none
- Business insights: top questions, lost sales, busy hours
- Targeted offers to past customers (opt-in)

WHO

Vodafone Egypt's **existing AI-as-a-Service**, packaged for SMEs · **guided self-setup** adds up to 30 customers a month

The result

One login, one bill on the Vodafone Business Digital Store. Vodafone becomes the SME's one place for AI

GO-TO-MARKET

Who first

Phone-heavy SMEs already with Vodafone: restaurants and clinics first, then brokers, service centres, salons

Where

Greater Cairo and Alexandria first, where SMEs are most concentrated

Channels

① Account Managers, starting with existing Vodafone business customers ② Missed-call reports for 010Hotline customers ③ Guided self-setup on the Digital Store (Phase 3) ④ Referrals: "refer a business, get a free month"

Priced so an SME earns the fee back from a small share of the calls it misses, while Vodafone keeps a 35-48% margin

All figures are illustrative assumptions, to be validated in the pilot

PRICING (PER MONTH, EXCL. VAT)

Plan	Price	Includes
Essential	EGP 1,500	300 AI conversations (calls + WhatsApp)
Plus	EGP 2,500	700 conversations, multi-branch
Extra	EGP 7 each	beyond the allowance, so Plus pays off above ~440

First month free, then billed monthly on the existing Vodafone bill · cancel any month

BUNDLING

- **Hotline + AI agent:** EGP 1,950 instead of 2,100 for new customers
- **SME bundle:** Hotline + AI agent + the business's staff mobile lines, 10% off

WHAT THE SME GETS BACK: TWO EXAMPLES

RESTAURANT · PLUS PLAN

~21

recovered orders a month cover the EGP 2,500 fee

- ~450 conversations a month (calls + WhatsApp), so **Plus**
- 60 orders recovered × EGP 300 at 40% profit = **EGP 7,200** (~2.9× the fee)
- + EGP 45-75 saved per order kept off an app

CLINIC · ESSENTIAL PLAN

~5

recovered bookings a month cover the EGP 1,500 fee

- 5 missed calls a day: ~130 conversations a month, so **Essential**
- EGP 1,500 ÷ EGP 300 a visit = **5 bookings**, while ~30 bookings a month are at risk

Fee = 1.8-3% of the smallest SME's monthly revenue · clinic figures are revenue, before costs

VODAFONE'S ECONOMICS PER ESSENTIAL CUSTOMER / MONTH

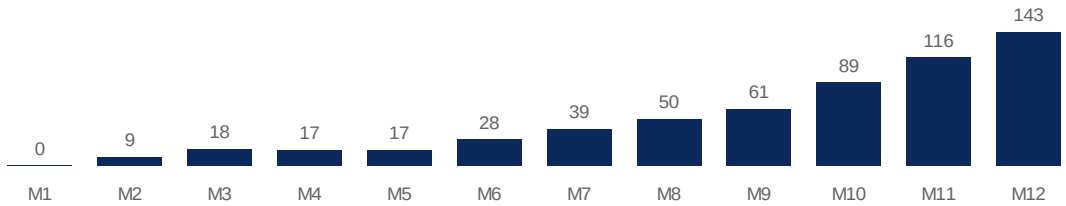
	EGP
Revenue	**1,500**
− AI usage (speech + language model)	350
− Calls & WhatsApp messaging	100
− Platform licence (Group / Google Cloud)	200
− Customer support	100
− Onboarding (~EGP 1,200 one-off ÷ 12 months)	100
− Sales commission (one month's fee, paid once ÷ 12)	125
= Contribution (Plus customers: ~48%)	**525 (35%)**

12-MONTH TARGETS, SIZED TO FIT DELIVERY CAPACITY

~145
paying SMEs by month 12
(year 1 proves the model)

EGP 1.1M
revenue in year 1
(EGP 3.3M run-rate at M12)

35-48%
margin per customer
(Essential to Plus)



Paying SMEs by month · 30 pilot setups, then 20 a month by the delivery team + 30 self-setups a month from M9 · 60% keep paying after the free month · 3% churn · ~EGP 1,900 average revenue

Sources: 010Hotline price from the Vodafone Business Digital Store; commission is an industry estimate. Other figures are assumptions to validate in the pilot: AI cost per conversation, licence terms, willingness to pay, missed-call volumes.

Reach the right SMEs, follow up on a fixed rhythm, and win them over with their own numbers, not technology talk

THE TWO BARRIERS IN THE BRIEF

"AI" sounds complicated: We never sell AI. We sell an outcome, "never miss a customer", under a name without "AI", and we show it instead of explaining it.

Almost everyone pushes back on price: We anchor on what they already lose, take away the risk with a free first month, and defend the price with value and bundles, not discounts.

1 Reaching customers

the right SMEs, through people they already trust

- **Start warm:** existing Vodafone business customers, beginning with 010Hotline accounts in phone-heavy sectors
- **Prioritise by need:** rank accounts by call volume from Vodafone's own billing data, so the busiest businesses are approached first
- **The right channel per segment:** Account Managers for larger accounts, telesales for smaller ones, Vodafone stores and Digital Store campaigns for walk-ins
- **Lead with an offer, not a product:** "Get a free report of the calls you missed last month"
- **Sector playbooks:** a one-page pitch and demo per sector, in the customer's own words (bookings, orders, viewings)

2 Following up

a fixed rhythm, and every lead has a next step

- **Day 0:** first call or visit; the missed-calls report is offered, with the owner's permission
- **Day 2:** report shown, plus a 3-minute live demo on the owner's phone, then the offer: sign up with the first month free
- **Day 5:** follow-up call to answer questions from the owner and anyone else who decides, like a partner or manager
- **Day 10:** last check; if the owner isn't ready, the lead moves to nurturing
- **Not ready yet:** a monthly missed-calls snapshot for 3 months, and a new offer before peak season (e.g. Ramadan)
- **In the CRM, no lead is left without a next action and a date;** the pipeline is reviewed weekly

3 Bringing them around

proof and low risk, not technology

- **Their loss first:** the report turns "AI" into numbers they recognise, calls missed and business lost
- **Show, don't explain:** the demo answers with the owner's own business information, in Egyptian Arabic
- **Remove the risk:** first month free, missed calls only, no setup fee, cancel any month
- **Defend the price with value:** compare the fee to recovered business (~5 bookings cover Essential); start small and upgrade later; add value with bundles, not discounts
- **Proof from peers:** pilot results and references from similar businesses in the same sector
- **Win the staff too:** the receptionist loses repetitive calls, not her job

PIPELINE MATH
per month in Phase 2

~100 SMEs contacted → **~40** missed-calls reports (40%) → **~20** sign-ups, first month free (50%) → **~12** still paying after month 1 (60%)

20 sign-ups a month matches what delivery can set up. **Account Managers are paid on customers who keep paying after the free month**, not on sign-ups.

After the deal closes: every customer goes live on a committed date, is accepted against clear criteria, and is supported until they see results

FROM CLOSED DEAL TO HAPPY CUSTOMER (AI CONCIERGE, ~5 WORKING DAYS TO GO LIVE)

1 Handover — Day 0
Sales passes the deal to delivery within 24 hours

2 Kick-off — Day 1
Plan and go-live date agreed; customer inputs requested

3 Set up — Days 2-3
Template, business information and rules configured

4 Acceptance test — Days 4-5
Owner tests it against the agreed checklist and signs off

5 Go live + training — Days 5-19
Staff trained, then 2 weeks of close support

6 Results review — Day 30
Value reviewed, then quarterly with the Account Manager

1 How we manage the delivery timeline

one repeatable flow for ~50 customers a month, across all solutions

1. **Plan:** at handover, each deal gets the standard plan for its solution, with an owner and a duration for every step; the go-live date is fixed at kick-off
2. **Prepare:** everything needed from the customer (business information, numbers, WhatsApp access) is collected up front, with a deadline
3. **Schedule:** a weekly capacity plan across all customers; similar setups are batched; AI Concierge uses at most 20 slots, with guided self-setup from Phase 3
4. **Track:** one tracker with every customer's stage and a red / amber / green status, reviewed in a short daily stand-up
5. **Escalate:** anything amber for 2 days goes to the delivery lead, and the customer is told before a date slips, with a new date

2 How we get sign-off from each customer

against criteria agreed at the start

1. **Agree:** acceptance criteria are written at kick-off for each solution
2. **Test:** the owner and staff run the acceptance test: real customer questions, a booking or order, a handover to staff, and the dashboard
3. **Fix:** each issue gets an owner and a date, and is re-tested within 48 hours
4. **Sign:** digital sign-off on WhatsApp or the Vodafone Business portal; nothing goes live without it
5. **Chase:** no reply means a reminder after 2 days, and the Account Manager after 5

3 How every customer lands with a great experience

adoption, not just installation

1. **Train:** a hands-on session for everyone who uses it (owner, receptionist, branch staff): reading the dashboard, editing answers, taking over a conversation, plus a short guide in Arabic
2. **Support closely:** 2 weeks of hypercare; conversations the AI couldn't finish are reviewed daily and fixed within 24 hours
3. **Collect feedback:** check-ins with owner and staff at week 1 and week 4, plus a satisfaction score; findings go back into templates and training
4. **Handle issues:** a clear support path (Vodafone support, then specialists, then Group / Google Cloud) with response times; if the AI fails, calls go straight to staff
5. **Roll out new features:** each new service (e.g. deposits and payment links in Phase 2) comes with a short guided session, staff try it before it is switched on, and usage is checked 2 weeks later
6. **Review results:** at day 30 and then every quarter with the Account Manager

Risks we manage in delivery: Egyptian Arabic accuracy (localised and tested before launch) · callers who prefer a person (they can ask at any time) · integration readiness (proven in the 30-customer pilot first) · data privacy (callers are told it's an assistant; only the owner sees conversations)

Prototype and financial model available on request